Less than a year later, I was speaking at the site of another World War II cemetery in Europe. It was a memorable experience for a different reason.

When I accepted an invitation from Chancellor Helmut Kohl to make a state visit to West Germany following the Bonn economic summit that was scheduled in the spring of 1985, I agreed with him that it would be an appropriate moment for us to mark not only the fortieth anniversary of the end of World War II, but also the beginning of forty years of peace and friendship between two former enemies. After I agreed to the visit, I received an invitation from a German politician who represented a region around Munich to visit Dachau, the infamous Nazi concentration camp located near Munich, during my trip. Since I was to be an official visitor of the federal government, I felt it wasn't up to me to choose my itinerary, so I turned down his invitation. (Subsequently I was told that the letter had come from one of Kohl's rivals, who wanted me to visit his district for his own political reasons.)

When the West German government announced that my projected itinerary would include a stop at a military cemetery at Bitburg, Jewish organizations in our country complained that among the two thousand or so buried there were forty-eight SS storm troopers—something our advance team hadn't known when they agreed to the schedule. The Jewish organizations argued that I should insist on canceling the visit to Bitburg and go instead to Dachau.

Even Nancy was against me this time. Excerpts from my diary will give readers an idea of what my life was like during this period:

> *April 4-14*
>
> During most of the week, the press has had a field day assailing me because I'd accepted Helmut Kohl's invitation to visit a German military cemetery during our visit to Bonn. I had turned down a not-official invite